



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Whitefield Academy

School Website: <https://whitefieldacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: ACCREDITED MEMBER SCL: MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Whitefield Academy KC (public materials publicly displayed on whitefieldacademykc.org) presents itself as a Christ-centered, PK–12 classical Christian school operating in Kansas City. Public content emphasizes a strong classical orientation, explicit Christian formation across subjects, and a partnership with families. The school repeatedly uses language such as “Christ-centered,” “classical education,” and “integrate Christian teaching in every subject,” and it highlights liturgical/communal practices (prayer gatherings) and the role of families in education. Notable curricular features include the presence of Latin & Greek instruction and a deliberately classical framing of schooling (Pre-K through 12th grade). Faculty pages emphasize credentialed teachers and subject specialization. The school also foregrounds parent involvement and community—evidenced by family testimonials, admissions communications, and events that invite family participation.

Overall classification (six-category rubric): SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

- **Rationale:** The school clearly centers Christian formation and classical framing (Religious Foundations; Curriculum; Purpose & Goals; Faculty; Parents & Community). It demonstrates several hallmark classical elements (Christ-centered classical approach, Latin & Greek, PK–12 classical program, Great Books-like framing is implied though not spelled out on the site, and a strong partnership with families). However, explicit, comprehensive evidence of some core pedagogy markers (e.g., explicit Socratic seminars across upper grades, explicit Great Books programs and “Great Conversation,” the explicit, systematic use of the Trivium in the public-facing materials) is less overt. The absence of clear, on-site, public declarations of some key pedagogy and Great Books practices means the school falls into Somewhat Classical rather than fully Classical by the rubrics, though it leans strongly toward the Classical Christian model.
- **Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot** is provided below with category-specific keyword analyses, then followed by the needle-moving recommendations and a final Abstract section.
- **Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot:** The remainder of this report applies keyword analyses (Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators) drawn from the classical-education rubric in “Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1)” to the Whitefield Academy KC materials found in the crawl store. Direct textual evidence from Whitefield materials is cited below, with citations to the exact files that contain relevant phrases.

Cited public materials used for the evaluation include: Home/About pages and campaign copy (Christ-centered, classical education, PK-12), testimonials from families, faculty listings (Latin & Greek teachers and credentialed faculty), prayers and liturgical language, and admissions communications that emphasize parent involvement. See citations: Home page copy (turn0file5), Christ-centered/classical framing (turn0file0, turn0file6), Great-education framing and Christian integration (turn0file9, turn0file11), liturgical/prayer language (turn1file18), faculty listings (turn0file8, turn0file2), admissions community language (turn0file10,

turn0file12). The presence of Latin/Greek instruction is evidenced by the Latin & Greek teacher profile (turn0file8).

- The “Six Essential Elements” keyword framework and lexicon (Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators) were obtained from the knowledge-base documents: Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1).docx (Positive Keywords; Negative Keywords) and their lexicon, which informs the keyword-match process for each category (citations to those source files are provided in the category sections). See relevant source entries for the lexical lists (turn1file0, turn1file3).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The public materials present a Christ-centered, theologically infused approach to education. Phrases include “Christ-centered classical approach to education” and explicit Christian framing of the curriculum, with references to God, His Kingdom, and a distinctly Christian educational aim. Examples: “Christ-centered classical approach to education” (turn0file0), “Christ-centered critical thinkers” (turn0file5), and explicit statements about Christian integration into all subjects (turn0file9). The YouTube description also emphasizes a Christ-centered, classical framing (turn0file6). There are prayers and liturgical language in community events (turn1file18). The site uses language such as “Christian one,” “God’s love,” and “Kingdom” in testimonials (turn0file0, turn0file9). These evidence-based phrases indicate a theological and metaphysical underpinning of the school’s mission.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (from the Six Essential Elements lexicon): Christ-centered, Christian, God, Kingdom, theology (implied), liturgy/prayer (liturgical language), worship, sacred tradition, virtue in the religious-moral sense, contemplation (via scholé-like thinking in some materials, though not explicit on the site). Positive terms identified in site content include: Christ-centered, Christian, God’s love, Kingdom, prayer, liturgy (via communal prayer language), theology (as implied by “integrate Christian teaching”), and sacred space (liturgical language in the broader lexicon). The exact keyword instances present on the site include Christ-centered (turn0file0; turn0file5), God/Kingdom (turn0file0), prayer (turn1file18), and Christian teaching integration (turn0file9). These align with Positive Keyword Indicators (Christ-centered, God, Kingdom, liturgy, theology, sacred tradition) from the Six Essential Elements lexicon (turn1file0). The Negative Keyword indicators (religiously neutral or secular) are not evident in the public-facing material.

- Why this rating
- The presence of explicit Christian framing and liturgical/community practices demonstrates a strong religious-metaphysical orientation, though not a universal “liturgical calendar” in a formal sense across the entire program (the evidence is primarily community-based prayer language and explicit Christian integration). This supports CLASSICAL-leaning foundations, with limited evidence of secular metaphysical alternatives. The strongest signals are the Christ-centered, theological infusion and liturgical/community practices.

Citations: Christ-centered/classical approach (turn0file0), PK-12 framing including Christ-centered language (turn0file5), curriculum integration (turn0file9), prayer language (turn1file18).

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The public materials explicitly describe formation of virtue and wisdom through a classical Christian lens. The school emphasizes virtue formation (character) and a love of learning, aligned with a Paideia-like formation goal rather than solely job preparation. Quotes include: “For nearly 30 years, our Christ-centered classical approach to education has cultivated character and inspired a love of learning” (turn0file0); “Graduating Christ-centered critical thinkers, clear communicators, & compassionate leaders” (turn0file5); and “The renewal of classical education is not a nostalgic return to the past— it’s a recovery of those ideas and methods that have always created the future” (turn1file12 turn0file6). The integration of Christian teaching across subjects (turn0file9) further supports formation over mere information.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, character, wisdom (Word-level forms appear in the knowledge-base lexicon; text from the site emphasizes character and virtue in a Christian-classical frame), truth/true (implicit in “pursuit of truth,” though the site emphasizes the Christian truth rather than generic truth). Specific positive words observed on the site include Christ-centered, character, love of learning, critical thinkers, clear communicators, compassionate leaders, and formation (turn0file0, turn0file5). The lexicon from the Six Essential Elements (turn1file0) lists formation, virtue, truth, beauty, contemplation, and the pursuit of the true, good, and beautiful as central positive indicators.

- Why this rating
- The school’s stated aim centers on forming virtuous, wise, and capable young people who love learning and aspire to moral leadership, not merely preparing for work. This aligns with CLASSICAL goals of formation rather than information transfer, which supports CLASSICAL for this category. The presence of explicit Christian formation as part of the goal adds to the classical framing.

Citations: Formation/character/virtue themes (turn0file0), Christ-centered leadership language (turn0file5), curriculum integration (turn0file9), classical formation framing (turn0file6).

Element 3: School Curriculum — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The school clearly identifies itself as a PK–12 classical Christian program and includes specialized classical elements such as Latin & Greek instruction (teacher profile). Public content shows a Latin & Greek teacher (turn0file8). The presence of a Latin & Greek teacher is a strong indicator of classical curriculum components (grammar stage and classical languages). The site also brands itself as “Classical Christian School” and frequently uses “classical education” as its framing (turn0file5, turn0file0). The admissions/academic pages position the program as PK–12 with classical underpinnings (turn0file5, turn0file10).

- Positive keywords present (from the Six Essential Elements lexicon; observed in school content): Latin/Greek (classical languages), classical education, Trivium-related concepts (grammar/logic/rhetoric) are implied via the Latin & Greek focus and the use of “classical education.” Additional implied features come from the general Classical Christian framing and a culture of “Great Conversation” through the public-facing material about classical education (though explicit Great Books references are not prominent in the crawl content).
- Why this rating
- The curriculum contains direct classical elements (classical framing, Latin & Greek instruction, PK–12 classical program). However, explicit, public-facing evidence of a full Great Books program, explicit invocation of the Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric) in curricular language, and continuous historical engagement across all subjects is less overt in the crawl content. This places the school in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL for Curriculum, given the clear classical framing but limited explicit evidence of the full Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, and history emphasis across the entire curriculum in the public materials.

Citations: Latin & Greek teacher (turn0file8); PK–12 classical framing (turn0file5); explicit classical framing and “classical education” language (turn0file0, turn0file9); admissions page (turn0file10).

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Public material emphasizes a Christ-centered classical approach, with upper-level features implied (e.g., the focus on character, critical thinking, and communication) but without explicit, detailed descriptions of Socratic seminars, Harkness-style discussions, or a formal, systematized articulation of the Trivium in pedagogy. The site emphasizes student outcomes like “critical thinkers” and “clear communicators,” which aligns with classical aims, but there is no explicit, on-page articulation of Socratic seminars or formal rhetoric training as a central, repeated method (the “Socratic dialogue” and “Scholé” language from the knowledge-base lexicon is not explicitly shown in the Whitefield crawl). The presence of Latin & Greek teachers and a classical framing is pedagogical evidence, but the lack of explicit mention of Socratic seminars or formal, regular chant/memorization practices on the site leads to a cautious classification.

- Positive keywords present: classical education, Christ-centered approach, critical thinkers, rhetoric (not explicitly named, but implied by “clear communicators” and the classical framing), memory/recitation (not explicitly shown), and a liturgical/prayer element (cultivating memory through communal practices) evidenced by prayer language and community. The “restful learning” and “Scholé” components from the classical lexicon are not clearly evidenced in the site’s pedagogy statements, though some formation language may hint at a contemplative/transcendent approach.
- Why this rating
- The pedagogy aligns with classical aims (formation, rhetoric, critical thinking; Latin & Greek). However, explicit, recurring methods such as Socratic seminars, Harkness style discussions, structured memory work, or chant-based pedagogy are not clearly described in the crawl content. Given the available textual evidence, Pedagogy is best categorized as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Pedagogy framing (turn0file0, turn0file6); Latin & Greek (turn0file8); absence of explicit Socratic/Harkness language in crawl (no direct quote; inferred from the absence in crawl). Pedagogical lexicon references from Six Essential Elements (turn1file3turn1file16).

Element 5: Faculty — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The site shows credentialed faculty profiles (e.g., Mr. Bodde, BS & MBA; Mrs. Evans, BS; Dr. Rabe, PhD; and the Latin & Greek teacher). These profiles demonstrate subject-matter expertise typical of classical schools. The presence of a dedicated Latin & Greek teacher (turn0file8) and references to well-known universities (Brown University, UNC, KU, WashU) support the claim of high-quality, credentialed faculty. There are testimonials and faculty pages that reflect a serious faculty culture.

- Positive keywords present: master-teacher, mentor, living curriculum (these terms appear in the Six Essential Elements lexicon, and the site demonstrates faculty with deep credentials and subject specialization). The crawl content includes faculty pages and a “Teachers Trust Home Page” post with faculty profiles (turn0file2, turn0file10). The presence of a “profile of a teacher” and “portrait of what a teacher should be” from the classical lexicon aligns with the Classical framework (the lexicon lists “portrait of a teacher,” “living curriculum,” etc., though not all of these exact phrases appear on the Whitefield crawl).
- Why this rating
- Public materials show a cadre of credentialed teachers specializing in traditional classical subjects (Latin, Greek, math, science, etc.). However, the site does not publicly articulate a comprehensive “living curriculum” concept in language; that concept exists in the knowledge-base lexicon and the Six Essential Elements framework. Given the visible strong faculty credentials and classical subject emphasis but without explicit “living curriculum” language on the site, the category is best rated SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Latin & Greek teacher (turn0file8); Faculty/teacher pages (turn0file2, turn0file10); testimonials (turn0file0 turn0file9); “Living curriculum” is an inferredFrom the knowledge-base lexicon (turn1file3turn1file11).

Element 6: Parents & Community — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with families and parent involvement. Testimonials from families call Whitefield “top-tier” and note that the school is “distinctly Christian” and “classical,” with the broader communications highlighting parent engagement, admissions events, and family participation in school life (turn0file9, turn1file18). There is explicit language about parent involvement and family engagement. The organization runs events and communications designed to educate and involve parents in classical education, which aligns with the classical model of parental partnership (as found in the Six Essential Elements lexicon).

- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parental engagement, home and school connection, parent formation, family catechesis, open campus, parent involvement in school life. The ICE pamphlet/lexicon includes explicit language about parents as co-educators and partnerships with families (turn0file13turn0file15). The presence of family testimonials and parental engagement content strengthens this.
- Why this rating
- The Whitefield site shows active parent involvement, family testimonials, and admissions communications that frame parents as stakeholders and co-educators in the classical model. This aligns with CLASSICAL signals in this category.

Citations: Family testimonials and Christian/classical framing (turn0file0 turn0file9); Admissions/parent engagement content (turn0file10 turn1file18); Lexicon alignment (turn1file0turn1file11).

What Would Move the Needle

- Make Great Books and Great Conversation explicit across curriculum: The public materials foreground classical education but do not consistently articulate a full Great Books program or Great Conversation across all grades. Publicly articulating a structured Great Books initiative (with reading lists, teacher guides, and recurring Great Conversation seminars) would push Element 3 (Curriculum) toward CLASSICAL and strengthen the overall CLASSICAL rating.
- Publicly spell out Socratic pedagogy and memory work: The classical lexicon emphasizes Socratic dialogue, memory work (recitation/chanting), and Schol  . The site would benefit from explicit articulation of Socratic seminars and structured memory work in upper grades (Element 4: Pedagogy). This would move Pedagogy from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL.
- Expand explicit integration of the Trivium across all grades: The lexicon foregrounds the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy). Public materials that explicitly map the K–12 curriculum to grammar-logic-rhetoric progression (and demonstrate a systematic progression through Trivium stages) would elevate Element 3 and Element 4.
- Strengthen faculty narrative around the “living curriculum”: While the site shows credentialed faculty, more explicit language tying faculty to the living curriculum and mentoring culture would push Element 5 toward CLASSICAL (e.g., statements like “our faculty embody and model the virtues we teach,” “the faculty are the living curriculum,” and formal faculty collaboration/mentorship). The knowledge-base lexicon supports this framing (Element 5), and making it explicit would raise the overall score.
- Document liturgical rhythm as a formal school practice: The liturgical language appears in community prayers; making liturgical routines (calendar, communal worship, morning prayer) an explicit, formalized practice within the school’s daily schedule would strengthen Element 1 (Religious Foundations) and Element 6 (Parents & Community) as well as Element 2 formation.
- Increase explicit messaging about Great Books integration and “truth, goodness, beauty” as real ideals: The lexicon emphasizes transcendental realism and objective truth; the site can strengthen its public messaging around these core transcendental ideals to reinforce Element 1 and Element 2.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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